

Dishoom: what their public marketing signals are actually saying

A short, evidence-based read of what's publicly visible — not internal data I don't have access to.

How this was built: every point below is checkable by anyone, using Dishoom's own public pages, their published llms.txt file, and independent reviews. Nothing here claims insight into revenue, covers, or internal reporting.

1. Brand storytelling — a real strength

- ❑ The "Journal" — recipes, city guides, "Dishoom Loves" cultural content — is a genuinely rare depth of content marketing for a restaurant group, not a token blog.
- ❑ A published cookbook and cook-at-home meal kits turn one-time diners into a repeat, at-home revenue line — most hospitality brands stop at the table.
- ❑ That combination gives Dishoom a reason to stay in touch with someone between visits, not just at the point of booking.

2. AI & search readiness — ahead of most competitors

- ❑ Dishoom publishes a structured llms.txt file — a genuinely uncommon, forward-thinking step that helps AI tools answer questions about them accurately, rather than guessing.
- ❑ That same file explicitly warns against quoting "outdated, generic booking rules" site-wide — a sign the team already knows the next finding is a real risk, not a surprise.
- ❑ Few hospitality brands of any size have gone this far in preparing for how AI tools will represent them to prospective customers.

3. Booking policy — a real expectation-setting risk

- ❑ The core policy — mainly walk-ins, limited reservations, rules that vary by café — is unusual for UK dining habits and independently confirmed by diner reviews mentioning an unexpected wait.
- ❑ Whether this is unmissable in the first line of every location page, or requires a visitor to already know to look, is the actual conversion question — not whether the policy itself is right.
- ❑ A visitor who plans an evening around a normal booking, then arrives to find otherwise, forms their first impression before they've even ordered.

4. Delivery — a real coverage gap

- ❑ Delivery runs in London and Manchester only — not Edinburgh, Glasgow or Birmingham, by Dishoom's own published information.
- ❑ For three of five UK cities, the honest answer to "can I get this delivered" is no — worth confirming that's clear on those specific city pages, not just in a postcode checker two clicks away.

What this pattern usually means: a brand this deliberate about storytelling and this early on AI-readiness rarely leaves conversion detail to chance by accident. The likelier explanation is a network that grew fast enough that policy pages, once genuinely consistent, now vary faster than the site's structure was built to communicate — which is a scaling problem, not a demand problem.

What I'd check first, in order

- 1 Put the booking policy in the first line, every location page.** If a walk-in policy is genuinely part of the experience, it should read as intentional immediately, not be discovered after a wasted trip.
- 2 State delivery availability directly on each city page.** Removes a redundant postcode-checker step for the three cities where the answer is already known and fixed.
- 3 Extend the llms.txt discipline to the pages themselves.** The same structured consistency already solved for AI tools would resolve the underlying human-facing inconsistency too.



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I review measurement, conversion paths and brand consistency for a living. If this kind of gap looks familiar in your own business, it's worth a proper look.

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